

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job.

Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> To answer this question , we need to look at the patient's symptoms and behavior .

The patient is experiencing feelings of sadness , hope lessness , and suicidal ide ations , which are all common symptoms of depression .

The patient's belief that his life is cursed and that bad things are likely to happen to him is also a common symptom of depression , known as " negative thinking ".

The patient's difficulty making decisions and his symptoms of guilt and poor concentration are also consistent with a diagnosis of depression .

The patient's age and the fact that he is able to hold a job despite his symptoms are also consistent with a diagnosis of depression .

The other options are less likely to be correct because there is no indication that the patient is at risk for double depression , which is a condition that typically occurs in people who have a history of depression and are also experiencing another type of illness , such as a thyroid condition .

There is also no indication that the patient is experiencing symptoms of man ia or psychosis , which are typically associated with different types of mental health conditions .

There is also no indication that the patient is likely to have paranoid personality disorder , as his symptoms are more consistent with depression than with a personality disorder .

Therefore , based on the patient's symptoms and behavior , it is likely that he is at risk for depression .

<answer> The patient is at risk for depression .